

Ethnography (1)

- Ethnography is a philosophy with a set of techniques that include participant observation and interviews
- Ethnographers immerse themselves in the culture that they study
- A researcher's degree of participation can vary along a scale from 'outside' to 'inside'
- Analyzing video and data logs can be time-consuming
- Collections of comments, incidents, and artifacts are made

Ethnography (2)

- Co-operation of people being observed is required
- Informants are useful
- Data analysis is continuous
- Interpretivist technique
- Questions get refined as understanding grows
- Reports usually contain examples

Observations and materials that might be collected (Crabtree, 2007)

- Activity or job descriptions.
- Rules and procedures that govern particular activities.
- Descriptions of activities observed.
- Recordings of the talk taking place between parties.
- Informal interviews with participants explaining the detail of observed activities.
- Diagrams of the physical layout, including the position of artifacts.
- Other information collected when observing activities:
 - Photographs of artifacts (documents, diagrams, forms, computers, etc.)
 - Videos of artifacts.
 - Descriptions of artifacts.
 - Workflow diagrams showing the sequential order of tasks.
 - Process maps showing connections between activities.